



Recruiter Quick Search — Product Requirements Document

Version 2.0 | July 24, 2026 | Status: Live (Vercel)

1. What It Does

A Chrome extension that lets recruiters look up a company without leaving the resume. Highlight any company name on any webpage, press `Ctrl+Shift+Y`, and a popup appears with an instant summary plus key facts. No new tabs, no Googling, no context-switching.

One flow, three seconds: Highlight → shortcut → read → dismiss.

2. Problem Statement

Context

During high-volume resume screening, recruiters frequently encounter unfamiliar company names and need to quickly verify their industry, legitimacy, and scale. A candidate's past employer is one of the strongest signals on a resume — but only if the recruiter can evaluate it.

The Problem

The current verification workflow is heavily fragmented. A recruiter must:

1. Highlight the company name
2. Right-click to search
3. Wait for a new tab to open
4. Scan through multiple search results
5. Piece together a mental summary from snippets
6. Close the tab and navigate back to the original document

This constant context-switching breaks focus, introduces cognitive friction, and significantly slows down the evaluation process.

Impact

Recruiters screen 50-100 resumes a day. Every unfamiliar company name forces this detour. Each one costs 15-30 seconds and breaks the recruiter's flow. Over a single day, that adds up to 20-50 context switches — wasted time, mental fatigue, and companies that get skipped rather than investigated.

This tool collapses that detour into a single keystroke on the same page.

3. What the Recruiter Sees

Trigger

- Highlight a company name anywhere (LinkedIn, PDF, Excel, job boards)
- Press `ctrl+shift+y` — or click the extension icon in the toolbar

The Popup

A floating card appears in the top-right corner of the page:

Company Lookup	×
Zerodha is an Indian financial services company founded in 2010, headquartered in Bengaluru, offering brokerage-free stock trading. It has over 7.5 million active clients. [cached]	
Founded:	2010
Headquarters:	Bengaluru
Size:	Not found
Revenue:	Not found
Funding:	Bootstrapped
Industry:	Financial Services
Leadership:	Nithin Kamath
Clients:	7.5 million
Visit Official Website	

Dismissal

- Click the × button
- Press `Escape`
- Click anywhere outside the popup

Cache

If you look up the same company again, it returns instantly with a green "cached" badge. The last 10 lookups are cached automatically.

4. What Data It Shows

Field	Description	Example
Summary	1-3 sentence narrative about the company	"Fintech company founded in 2010..."
Founded	Year the company was established	2010
Headquarters	City and country	Bengaluru
Size	Employee count or range	4,000 employees
Revenue	Annual revenue estimate	\$250M
Funding	Total funding raised, or "Bootstrapped"	\$433M
Industry	Sector the company operates in	Financial Services
Leadership	CEO or founder names	Nithin Kamath
Clients	User/customer count or notable names	7.5 million
Official Link	Direct link to company website	zerodha.com

Fields that can't be found show "Not found" — the tool never guesses.

5. How It Works (Non-Technical)

1. You highlight text and trigger the extension
2. The extension sends the company name to a backend API on Vercel
3. The backend searches the web using the Tavily Search API
4. Results are parsed into a summary + 8 structured data points
5. The popup renders everything on the same page
6. Repeated lookups hit an in-memory cache (instant)

The entire round-trip takes 2-4 seconds. If the backend is waking up from idle (Vercel cold start), it may take up to 5 seconds — a loading message is shown.

6. Error Handling

Situation	What the recruiter sees
No text highlighted	"Please highlight a company name first."
Searching	"Searching for 'CompanyName'..."
Company not found	"No information found for 'CompanyName'."
Network issue	"Could not reach the backend. Check your connection."
Backend error	A clear error message, no crash

The extension never breaks the host page. On restricted pages (chrome://, edge://), it silently does nothing.

7. Current Limitations & Known Issues

Issue	Impact	Status
Ambiguous company names	Search may blend data from similarly-named companies	Mitigated with exact-phrase matching
Obscure/very new companies	May return "No information found"	Acceptable for now
Cold start delay	First lookup after idle takes 3-5s	Loading state shown
India bias is keyword-based	Not a geo-filter, just query prioritization	Works for most Indian companies

8. What's Planned Next

- Serper (Google Search) as a fallback API when Tavily returns no results
 - Government startup database APIs for Indian company data (Startup India, MCA registry)
 - Improved disambiguation for companies with shared or similar names
 - Copy-to-clipboard button on the popup for pasting into ATS notes
 - Dark mode detection to match the host page theme
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9. Technical Summary (For Developers)

Component	Technology
Browser Extension	Chrome Manifest V3, vanilla JS
Backend	FastAPI (Python), deployed on Vercel
Primary Search	Tavily Search API (AI-powered answers)
Cache	In-memory LRU, last 10 lookups
API Keys	Stored in Vercel environment variables

Files:

- `extension/` — `manifest.json`, `background.js`, `content.js`, `icons/`
- `backend/` — `main.py`, `requirements.txt`, `vercel.json`

Endpoints:

- `POST /lookup` — returns `{ summary, details: {...}, source, link, cached }`
- `GET /health` — returns `{ status: "ok" }`

Response time: 2-4 seconds